



Soyuz
1967



Space Shuttle
1981

Quest for power

As rockets have become more powerful their shapes have changed. The latest ones carry shuttles into space.

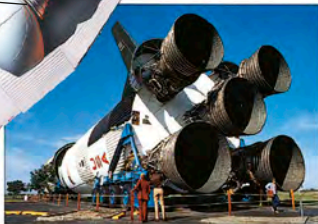
Service
Module

Launch
Escape
System

Command Module

Lunar
Module

Rocket
engine



Overpowering

See just how enormous Saturn V's engines are compared to these people!

Five rocket
engines

... and away

To escape from Earth by rocket you have to travel at 25,000 miles (40,000 kilometers) per hour—more than 40 times faster than a jet.

Safe landing

The Falcon 9 rocket can leave Earth and soar into outer space before returning safely to Earth afterward and doing it all over again.

